

Safety Sweep Checklist

Completing a thorough safety sweep of the home is an important part of keeping an at-risk person safe. You are looking for anything that may be used as a weapon to cause self-harm. These items should be removed from the home or locked away so that the person at risk cannot access them. It should be noted that this is not an all inclusive list of items but a detailed listing to provide guidance in addressing safety concerns in your home. For an online tutorial about means restriction please visit: www.hennepin.us/saferhome

Weapons:

- Guns, ammunition
- Heavy tools

Knives and Sharp Objects:

- Kitchen knives (steak knives, cooking knives, butter knives)
- Cleavers, blade-type cheese cutters, 2-prong turning forks, skewers
- Plastic toothpicks, plastic eating utensils
- Pocket knives, or sport knives (for hunting and fishing)
- Decorative knives or swords
- Razor blades, including disposables
- Manicuring tools, metal callous remover
- Hand mirrors
- Glass – picture frames, figurines, and other decorative items
- Light bulbs
- CDs or CD cases
- Paper clips, pins (safety pins, etc.), needles
- Pencils and pens
- Nails and screws
- Tools – awl, screwdriver, hammer, saw, ax, hatchet

Substances:

- ALL medications- prescribed and over the counter
- Mouthwash
- Aerosols
- Cleaning and laundry products
- Paint and solvents – turpentine, thinner, oils, lighter fluid
- Lighters, matches, candles

Choking Hazards:

- Shoelaces, belts
- Chains, necklaces
- Electrical and detachable cords
- Window blind/curtain cords
- Bed linens and clothing
- Plastic bags